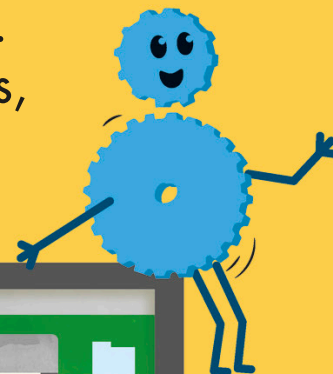


Computers

A computer is a machine that lets you work with information, such as words, pictures, or videos. We call computer information **data**. Instructions, called programs, tell the computer what to do.



The **screen** shows you what you're typing on the keyboard. You can also use it to see photos, watch movies, play games, and surf the Internet.

Speakers play music and other sounds.

Data is stored on **memory chips** and **magnetic disks** inside the computer.

You move and tap your fingertip over the **touch pad** to select things on the screen.

The power to run the computer comes from a built-in **battery**.

The **keyboard** lets you type letters, numbers, and symbols.

Other devices, such as memory sticks, can be plugged into outlets called **ports**.

Storing data

Computer data needs to be saved so that it can be shared and used again. The way data is stored has changed a lot since the early days of computers.



Punched tape

In the 1950s, computers stored data as holes punched into tape.



Floppy disk

From the 1970s, data was stored as magnetic patterns on a thin disk.



CD (compact disc)

Data is stored as patterns of tiny pits in the surface of the disc.